

Test 2 answer key

Reading and Use of English



Answer key
with extra
explanations in
Resource Bank

Part 1

1 D 2 B 3 A 4 B 5 C 6 C 7 A 8 B

Part 2

9 whose 10 had 11 what 12 other 13 rather 14 which
15 although / though / while / whilst 16 in

Part 3

17 unlikely 18 response 19 medicinal 20 invisible 21 Scientists
22 location(s) 23 survival 24 truly

Part 4

25 had not / hadn't spent | so MUCH
26 is/'s REGARDED | as
27 only does/can Paul | DANCE well
28 made up | your MIND (about) OR made your | MIND up (about)
29 get ROUND to | writing
30 WHETHER she | had/'d

Part 5

31 D 32 C 33 C 34 A 35 A 36 D

Part 6

37 C 38 D 39 G 40 E 41 A 42 B

Part 7

43 D 44 C 45 A 46 B 47 B 48 A 49 D 50 A 51 C 52 B

Test 2 answer key

Listening

Part 1

1 B 2 B 3 B 4 C 5 B 6 A 7 B 8 A



Answer key
with extra
explanations in
Resource Bank

Part 2

9 pollution 10 (dark) cliffs 11 (sound of) waves 12 rain / shower(s) 13 signs
14 paintwork 15 castle 16 radio tower 17 cows 18 hills

Part 3

19 G 20 B 21 D 22 H 23 F

Part 4

24 C 25 A 26 B 27 A 28 C 29 B 30 B

Audioscript

Test Two.

I am going to give you the instructions for this test. I shall introduce each part of the test and give you time to look at the questions. At the start of each piece you will hear this sound:

tone

You will hear each piece twice.

Remember, while you are listening, write your answers on the question paper. You will have five minutes at the end of the test to copy your answers onto the separate answer sheet.

There will now be a pause. Please ask any questions now, because you must not speak during the test.

[pause]

Now open your question paper and look at Part One.

[pause]

PART 1

You will hear people talking in eight different situations. For questions 1 to 8, choose the best answer (A, B or C).

Question 1 *You hear a woman talking to her husband about watching birds in the garden.*

[pause]

tone

Man: Are you watching the birds again?!

Woman: Yeah – just sitting here looking into the garden, I've been watching them go about their business – keeping a beady eye on me! – and it's quite fascinating. They check out the trees and hedges to decide whether it's a good location for their nest, then collect bits and pieces to build it with. When they've had their babies, they have to find food. And later you see the parents encouraging their little ones to fly! The following year they go through it all again. Apparently, some even come back to the same tree – not that I can recognise individual birds!

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Question 2 *You hear two friends talking about the relationship between music and maths.*

[pause]

tone

Woman: You're musical, aren't you?

Man: A bit.

Woman: Are you as good at maths as you are at music?

Man: Never thought about it. Why?

Woman: Well, some researchers say listening to music helps cognition and maths skills, and that if a kid gets a bit behind their classmates at school, listening to more music can help them catch up. Apparently, even Albert Einstein used to play the piano when he was struggling with a maths problem – he reckoned it increased his brain power. Anyway, exactly how much a student benefits depends on the type of music they listen to and whether they choose to learn an instrument. Well, I think that's the gist of it.

Man: Interesting!

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Test 2 answer key

Question 3

You hear two friends talking about writing short stories.

[pause]

tone

Woman: You've written some short stories, haven't you?

Man: Yes, a few. But I struggled making my characters realistic. You?

Woman: Well, I thought my heroes were quite good! But I've started this creative writing course and it's harder than expected. You have to create this 'arc' – at school we used to say every story needs a beginning, middle and end. Somehow the way it finishes has to link back to the beginning.

Man: That was another problem of mine ... how to make an impact in the final sentences.

Woman: That's my weak area – it's lack of imagination, I guess. I don't seem to have a problem with the first few lines, though.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Question 4

You hear two friends talking about running.

[pause]

tone

Man: You've taken up running recently, right?

Woman: Yeah, I've been doing a bit of jogging in the park several times a week ... gradually increasing the distance I cover each time.

Man: Mmm, running on city streets is no fun.

Woman: There's too much pollution. When there are trees and stuff around, though, you just switch off from all your troubles. I was warned I'd hurt my knees if I got into running too heavily, but by progressing at it moderately, rather than going all out, that doesn't seem to be an issue. I don't find it hard to find the motivation to run most days, but I know some people find it monotonous.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Question 5 *You hear a woman telling her friend about a holiday in the mountains.*

[pause]

tone

Man: How was your holiday in the mountains?

Woman: Awesome! Of course, we couldn't always get exactly what we wanted to eat, because we were so far from anywhere. But if it's classy cuisine you're after, there are plenty of other places you can go for that!

Man: True! What about the hiking?

Woman: Well, we climbed some high peaks, and the mountains looked amazing for miles around – it was stunning, and we were lucky with the weather. We barely noticed the places where we stayed at night – we were so exhausted at the end of every day. We slept fantastically well – it must have been all the fresh air!

Man: Sounds wonderful!

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Question 6 *You hear two friends talking about the discovery of a new organ in the human throat.*

[pause]

tone

Man: Listen to this! 'Scientists have discovered a new organ in the human throat.' Apparently, they accidentally discovered it when researching an unrelated health condition. It makes saliva in the upper throat to help us swallow food more easily.

Woman: How on earth can they not have known about it?

Man: Something to do with where it's located – it's only just visible. But anyway, we still don't know everything about the human body – like, a large part of how the brain works is still a mystery. I mean, a lot of discoveries are made when people are actually looking for something else and that's what's happened here.

Woman: I wonder what else they'll discover!

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Test 2 answer key

Question 7 *You hear a man telling a friend about a newspaper article he's just read.*

[pause]

tone

Man: Have you read this article in the local newspaper, about car drivers going along the lanes in the road reserved for cyclists?

Woman: Oh, that again – they've been talking about that for ages.

Man: Mm, well, I agree it's something they keep going on about, almost to the point where it risked getting boring. But according to this, the writer's actually been collecting evidence, and from what I can see it looks convincing.

Woman: Well, now you come to mention it, I have witnessed a few incidents myself.

Man: Right ... I think I might look online and see what other stories I can find about it – especially as I cycle to work occasionally.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

Question 8 *You hear a man talking about surfing.*

[pause]

tone

Man: It's pretty obvious surfing's a challenging sport – it's a mental battle as well as a physical one. When I began, I was often overwhelmed by how difficult it was, constantly comparing myself to other surfers. I was very impatient with myself for not mastering skills faster and quit for a while. It takes years of practice, I discovered. Looking back, if I'd been in better shape I'd have had better balance, board control and stamina while in the water, and ultimately would have learned to surf more quickly. One thing some people don't realise is that to purchase a surfboard and other kit could cost well over a thousand dollars, and that's a fairly modest estimate.

[pause]

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

That is the end of Part One.

Now turn to Part Two.

PART 2

You will hear a man called Dave Barrett talking on his cycling podcast about a tour he did of Jersey by bike. For questions 9 to 18, complete the sentences with a word or short phrase.

You now have forty-five seconds to look at Part Two.

[pause]

tone

Welcome to my cycling podcast. I'm Dave. I'm a taxi driver, and when I'm not driving a cab around the city, I'm cycling, getting fit and seeing new sights. My last cycle trip was to Jersey, one of the islands between England and France.

I was desperate to be somewhere different from the city for a few days – I just wanted to be somewhere without pollution. I've got used to the noise and bustle, and the feeling of sitting in a cab all day, and even the pressure from passengers worried about getting to their destination on time. I still look forward to my holidays though.

The ferry journey from the English coast takes over ten hours and it was early evening when the boat drew into Jersey's harbour just after sunset. England's south coast is known for its vast white cliffs, but the dark ones of Jersey looked just as stunning. The ferry sailed in past rocks reflecting the lights of the harbour.

I cycled off the ferry to the hotel I'd booked, where I bedded down after a quick ride and a fish and chip dinner. The hotel was right next to a restaurant, so you could hear customers coming and going till late. It was September, so the breeze was cool, and with my head on the pillow the sound of waves was really calming despite the seagulls squawking noisily.

I woke up early and looked out of my window and noticed a light mist was hanging across the water. Thank goodness, there was clearly no chance of the showers the forecast had predicted. In fact, by around nine the sunshine was quite strong.

I set off after breakfast and was soon out of town riding along country lanes, before heading down to one of the coastal routes. Jersey's great for cyclists, and I'd heard about the speed restrictions for cars that make it really safe for people of all ages to enjoy a bike ride. If I'd known how many signs there are wherever you go, I needn't have worried so much about planning my routes beforehand.

Then I cycled down a long beach path – something I regretted. First I got loads of sand in my bike chain, but I saw what was going on and came off the path to check. It was only then I spotted some damage. It was to the paintwork ... maybe from a stone thrown up by a wheel. If I'd seen it, I'd have come off the path earlier.

Up on a higher path, I sat down to gaze up at the blue skies and around at the blue sea. The bay all around was truly beautiful, but when I set off again, I almost hit a pedestrian, as I wasn't paying attention to where I was going. That was 'cos of a castle. It had just come into view and looked really amazing.

I had some options when making up my mind where to take a break from cycling. I was sorely tempted by the museum, though I'd also heard about the radio tower. After much hesitation, that eventually appealed most. It's high up, and you can see the lighthouse out on the rocks. Definitely worth it. I reckon anyone with kids'd be better off opting for the fun park though.

I was hoping to come across some animals in Jersey. It's known for its red squirrels, which are visible at certain times of year, but I must have missed the season. Jersey's rich creamy milk is legendary and a herd of cows blocked my path at one point. I wished I'd had time to take a boat trip too, as the dolphins are another popular sight.

Test 2 answer key

I discovered just how good Jersey is for cycling, and there were quite a few other cyclists, groups and solo riders like me. It's got lots of hills. I'd always had this impression it was pretty flat from things I'd seen on TV, but I was wrong. Anyway, it's also full of walkers and joggers, as well as day-trippers who've come over on the ferry.

[pause]

Now you will hear Part Two again.

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

That is the end of Part Two.

Now turn to Part Three.

PART 3

You will hear five short extracts in which people are talking about their university experience away from home. For questions 19 to 23, choose from the list (A to H) what each speaker regrets about the experience. Use the letters only once. There are three extra letters which you do not need to use.

You now have thirty seconds to look at Part Three.

[pause]

tone

Speaker 1

I got sent loads of stuff about my engineering degree course before the first term, plus there were online forums with posts from former students. It'd have made things easier if I'd paid more attention to all that guidance. As it was, I felt overwhelmed as there was so much to take on board. As several mates were also doing the same course, the whole thing hadn't seemed such a big deal and I'd been a bit over-confident. It took a while to get to grips with things, but I sorted myself out, and soon I'd established a routine – I could have fun with other students and get my work done too.

[pause]

Speaker 2

When I left university, I was a completely different person from the one I was at the beginning – more confident, more independent, and *somewhat* more knowledgeable about history, which was what I studied, following in the footsteps of my dad and older brother. I'd have done a whole lot better if I'd followed their advice though and done my assignments in advance rather than the day before the deadlines. I'd been nervous about going off to university by myself, but I got in with a group of people studying the same subject early on, and to be honest, I chose to let my social life take over a bit.

[pause]

Speaker 3

Being in a new city and living on a tight budget are both challenges, but for me they were made less so by the fact that after leaving school I'd saved up and travelled around on my own a bit. But leaving my mum and dad at home and going to university still gave me butterflies in my stomach – not to mention the thought of all the course work I'd have. Luckily, my tutors were approachable, and I could always go to them for help. I just wish I'd made the most of some of the university clubs and societies as I'd have met more people. I focussed rather heavily on getting a good degree.

[pause]

Speaker 4

I remember being constantly hard-up at university. My parents couldn't give me financial support, so I worked in restaurants in a nearby town to make ends meet, and that meant fewer hours for coursework. The course staff said I needed to do a lot more, and even though I was disciplined and followed a strict study schedule, opting out of most social events, there was no way I could do everything, which is a real shame. But studying was the whole reason I was there. I only just scraped through but at least I still ended up with some really good mates – people I shared an apartment with, plus some from my course.

[pause]

Test 2 answer key

Speaker 5

I was lucky to be on a university campus in a beautiful part of the country ... I could go for walks and stuff when coursework got a bit heavy. There was so much to see and do round there. I'd never had to look after myself before, doing laundry, buying food. I didn't realise how expensive and time-consuming all that kind of stuff can be. It was only when I got there that I realised how unprepared I was, and wished I'd got more tips from my parents. My course tutors were great, although sometimes they could've gone into more detail in feedback on my essays and things.

[pause]

Now you will hear Part Three again.

tone

[The recording is repeated.]

[pause]

That is the end of Part Three.

Now turn to Part Four.

PART 4

You will hear an interview with a tree surgeon called Andrew Smith, who carries out work on trees to make sure they're healthy and safe. For questions 24 to 30, choose the best answer (A, B or C).

You now have one minute to look at Part Four.

[pause]

tone

Interviewer: Today we're talking to Andrew Smith, who's a tree surgeon. Andrew works on trees to make sure they're in good condition and not likely to damage people or property. How did you become a tree surgeon, Andrew?

Andrew: My dad's a tree surgeon and, as a child, I sometimes watched him working. I also learned a lot about trees – and the birds and other creatures that live in them – from him. After college I joined an IT company, but it quickly became clear to me I couldn't stand being inside for hours on end every day. So, I asked my dad if I could work with him – he had his own tree-care firm. He'd always avoided putting pressure on me to follow him into the business, but he was happy to take me on.

Interviewer: Can you remember the first tree you cut down?

Andrew: Yes. It was eight years ago – an oak tree had died and needed removing. The whole job took two days. Dad said I did well, which was nice, though by the end I was so exhausted, I couldn't really appreciate what I'd done. Tree care's obviously very physical work, but the way you climb – with ropes rather than grabbing branches and pulling yourself up – requires techniques that can take ages to get right. I hadn't realised that, even though I'd watched tree surgeons working.

Interviewer: Do you enjoy working with your father?

Andrew: Yes – we're not that different in some ways. He's very thorough – he tries not to leave anything to chance – but if problems occur, which happens when you work with trees, he doesn't panic. And I think he's passed all that on to me. What I'm not always so good at – and I admire this about him – is thinking in broader terms and judging what the best way ahead will be. Hopefully, I'll learn.

Interviewer: Tell me about a job you've done for a client recently.

Andrew: OK. A client was worried that two trees in her garden might fall onto her neighbour's roof. One was an old pear tree, which could easily have come down in a strong wind. I showed the lady evidence that it was rotten and suggested removing it. The other tree was an ash. I explained that it had some diseased branches which needed cutting. The next morning, I went back with a couple of guys, and by lunchtime, we'd done everything. The lady said she was delighted – she'd assumed we'd be there for a few days.

Interviewer: What do you like most about your job?

Andrew: You can't do this work on your own – you need workmates, and this way of working definitely suits the way I am. There's also a sense of progression – you can never know everything there is to know about trees, for example, and I regularly do courses and read research. What appeals to me more than anything, though, is that we help to make public places – parks, squares and streets – safe but also beautiful.

Interviewer: And what's the worst part?

Test 2 answer key

- Andrew: I can't say I always enjoy the last stage of a job – clearing away the dust, leaves, broken branches and cut up logs. I'd rather do that than fill in the risk assessment forms, safety checklists and so on that come with every job, though. That stuff has to be done, but it's definitely not my thing. Tree surgeons often complain it's too hot to work, or too cold – and you can't climb trees and use powerful electrical tools if it's snowing or even raining hard. A varied climate has its plus points, though.
- Interviewer: How do you see your future as a tree surgeon?
- Andrew: Well, the work's so tough physically it becomes too difficult after a certain age, and I have to plan for that. Eventually, maybe in my forties, I'll do more of what my dad does now – the business side of things, giving advice. With climate change, there's a fast-growing awareness of how important trees are for the world and tree surgeons are experts. Hopefully, the value of what we know will be increasingly recognised, and we'll get better paid too – tree surgeons generally don't earn what they deserve.
- [pause]
- Now you will hear Part Four again.*
- tone
- [The recording is repeated.]
- That is the end of Part Four.*
- There will now be a pause of five minutes for you to copy your answers onto the separate answer sheet. Be sure to follow the numbering of all the questions. I shall remind you when there is one minute left, so that you are sure to finish in time.*
- [pause – four minutes]
- You have one more minute left.*
- [pause – one minute]
- That is the end of the test. Please stop now. Your supervisor will now collect all the question papers and answer sheets.*